

INT. RESTAURANT - NIGHT - 2035

NEXT WEEK

Written by

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PRODUCTION FINAL - SCENE-LABELED REVISION

SCENE 01

STEPHANIE DAY ARRIVES AT GIALLO'S

EXT/INT GIALLO'S - DAY - AMBER

Low amber light. Carefully calibrated shadows. The kind of place designed for privacy.

A preserved mahogany bar runs the length of the room.

Smart-glass selves glow softly behind the bottles, displaying tasting notes in faint script.

The restaurant is nearly empty.

Soft R&B hums-no visible speakers.

Stephanie (early 30s) enters.

Toned. Athletic. Polished. Striking in a way that reflects discipline, not vanity.

She moves with measured grace-not rushed, not wandering. Intentional.

The door seals softly behind her.

As she walks, recessed floor sensors make faint guiding lights beneath her steps.

She doesn't look down. She knows this place.

A SERVER (20s), multi-colored hair, threaded with fiber-optic strands, approaches. Her wrist cuff glows softly-order and table history hoovers.

SERVER

Same time. Same table?

STEPHANIE

Yes, of course.

Stephanie reaches the same back corner table.

Stephanie slips wireless micro-buds into her ears as she takes her seat. Automatically syncing with a soft chime.

Her name appears in microscopic script in front of her.

WELCOME BACK, STEPHANIE.

She smiles. The text disappears.

Stephanie maintains Perfect posture. Too perfect.

Her head begins to sway-slow, intimate. Music only she hears.

SCENE 02

MAN SEARCH INTERFACE - SERVER TEA BEAT

INT GIALLO'S - STEPHANIE'S TABLE - DAY

ON DISPLAY: MAN SEARCH - AVATAR Match Interface

A facial recognition scan activates automatically.

She disables it. Chooses manual entry. She types.

USER ID: Steph9@Spacemail.StarPASSWORD:*****3

Her typing speed is flawless. No hesitation.

The homepage loads. Profiles rise in holographic form.

The SERVER arrives before Stephanie can order. Already carrying tea.

SERVER

You always skip dinner when you're
anxious.

Stephanie looks up. Controlled.

STEPHANIE

I'm never anxious.

The Server smirks like she's heard that before.

Stephanie glances at the floating holographic profiles
drifting above the table. Perfect smiles. Perfect metrics.

STEPHANIE

Do people actually find love here?

The Server follows her gaze. A beat.

SERVER

Depends what you're looking for.

Stephanie leans back slightly. Thinking.

STEPHANIE

Hmmmm there are levels to love.

The Server walks away. Stephanie watches her go. Then turns

back toward the flowing profiles floating in the dark.

Stephanie checks her interests:

MEN-true love, marriage minded, handsome, tall, financially stable, educated, emotionally mature.

DATA scrolls beside them:

Education Level. Income Verification. Psychological Stability Index. Reproductive Intentions. Fitness Metrics. Genetic Risk Profile. Emotional Stability Score. Sexual Performance Scores.

Stephanie studies them like an investor reviewing portfolios.

SCENE 03

DIGITAL MAN #1 - FINANCE PROFILE

INT GIALLO'S - STEPHANIE'S TABLE - DAY

DIGITAL MAN #1: Height-Standard. MBA-Finance. Financially secure.

She taps ENGAGE. MATCH ACTIVE.

Digital Man #1 materializes across from her, smug smile.

DIGITAL MAN #1

As listed, I value high-performance partnerships and common goals.

STEPHANIE

What does high value mean to you?

DIGITAL MAN #1

A man who earns 6 figures, takes care of his woman, provides everything she wants and needs.

She watches his smile and perfect teeth. Her pupils contract-micro-analysis.

STEPHANIE

You think you know what I want?

Digital Man smirks.

DIGITAL MAN #1

A real man knows what his woman wants.

Stephanie shoots Digital Man #1 an inquisitive look.

STEPHANIE

How do you handle conflict?

He smiles. Too confidently.

DIGITAL MAN #1

I'm non-violent.

(pause)

However, I will curse a

motherfucker out if...

Stephanie calmly raises a finger. Jabs Digital Man #1

POP. Digital Man #1 explodes into fragments.

MATCH TERMINATED.

NEXT CANDIDATE LOADING

SCENE 04

DIGITAL MAN #2 - ACTOR-MODEL PROFILE

INT GIALLO'S - STEPHANIE'S TABLE - DAY

DIGITAL MAN #2 Tall. Actor/Model. Financially secure. Well-Educated.

She taps ENGAGE. MATCH ACTIVE.

Digital Man #2 appears in the seat across from her. Relaxed. Attractive. Too polished. He smiles like he already knows the outcome.

DIGITAL MAN #2

Aren't you a rare one?

Stephanie studies him. Guarded. Pupils dilated-analyzing.

STEPHANIE

Rare?

DIGITAL MAN #2

You get to choose.

STEPHANIE

Choose what?

He leans forward slightly. A confident grin.

DIGITAL MAN #2

Me.

Stephanie doesn't smile. Instead, she tilts her head. Evaluating.

STEPHANIE

Where do you see yourself in five years?

Digital Man #2 shifts tone instantly. More sincere.

DIGITAL MAN #2

Will you penalize me for being honest?

STEPHANIE

It depends.

A flicker of amusement crosses his face.

DIGITAL MAN #2

I'm a dinosaur.

Stephanie nods.

STEPHANIE

Authentic humans. Not many left.

His smile fades slightly. For the first time, something almost genuine slips through.

DIGITAL MAN #2

AI's taking over.

(beat)

I honestly don't know what I'll be doing in five years. Technology's moving too fast.

(beat)

Humans lose our value with every software update.

Stephanie watches him carefully now. Studying.

DIGITAL MAN #2

I'm living day to day.

STEPHANIE

So why are you here?

He leans back. Smiles again. Charm returning like muscle memory.

DIGITAL MAN #2

Honestly? I was hoping to find someone that could use me. Someone like you.

Stephanie's eye narrow slightly.

DIGITAL MAN #2

I'm attractive, adaptable, intelligent.... and VERY good in bed.

A beat.

DIGITAL MAN #2

I could make a professional woman very happy.

Silence. Stephanie calmly raises a finger.

DIGITAL MAN #2

You said I wouldn't be penalized
for honesty.

STEPHANIE

I said, it depends.

Stephanie jabs Digital Man #2

POP. Digital Man #2 explodes into fragments.

MATCH TERMINATED.

NEXT CANDIDATE LOADING:

SCENE 05

SERVER - BEARDED MAN INTERLUDE

INT GIALLO'S - BAR + STEPHANIE'S TABLE

Server returns with sliced lemons.

SERVER

You're hard to impress tonight.

STEPHANIE

I'm just wired different.

The Server refills her tea. At the bar, a thin, BEARDED MAN notices Stephanie. He takes a deep breath, then exhales slowly, adjusts his clothes, smells under his arms and checks his breath. Turns up a beer bottle, gargles, swallows and rechecks his breath. He gathers courage. Approaches.

BEARDED MAN

Excuse me...are you looking for the perfect man?

The Server suppresses a laugh. Turns and walks away. Stephanie looks up with a blank expression.

STEPHANIE

I'm sorry.

BEARDED MAN

Sorry. That sounded cool in my head.

Stephanie releases a chuckle.

BEARDED MAN

You've been sitting here rejecting holograms for twenty minutes. I figured I'd save you the search because I got everything you looking for.

STEPHANIE

Are you on the app?

BEARDED MAN

Well, that app wouldn't post my profile. We have red blood cell

chemistry.

Stephanie looks at him. A tiny authentic smile.

Stephanie POV. Overlay data on Bearded Man is missing.

STEPHANIE

I'm not interested. Not enough data
for me to know who you are.

BEARDED MAN

That's fair, I guess.

(beat)

Still hurts though. I'm standing
right here. Ask me whatever you
want.

Stephanie stares blankly at him. Reaches up to pop, ends up
poking him in the ribs. Slightly shocked when he doesn't
pop. She tries to pop him again.

BEARDED MAN

Heard.

He nods respectfully. Returns to the bar.

Stephanie returns to the app. Breathes a sign of relief.

SCENE 06

DIGITAL MAN #3 - DOCTOR PROFILE

INT GIALLO'S - STEPHANIE'S TABLE - DAY

DIGITAL MAN #3: Doctor. Handsome. Sophisticated. "Wants children."

Stephanie taps: ENGAGE.

DIGITAL MAN #3 materializes across from her with the calm you would expect from a physician. Confident. Composed. Someone trusted.

DIGITAL MAN #3
Family is my top priority.

His tone is warm. Too warm. Stephanie's pupils dilate. It's not genuine.

STEPHANIE
A beautiful family?

The doctor thinks and then nods.

DIGITAL MAN #3
Well sure. And I'm sure you'd make a beautiful family.

STEPHANIE
Could you love me if I wasn't beautiful?

A beat. He hesitates. His expression flickers-searching parameters.

DIGITAL MAN #3
Physical attraction is important component. What's inside counts more.

She doesn't react.

DIGITAL MAN #3
May I ask you something?

STEPHANIE
Sure.

DIGITAL MAN #3

Do you believe in traditional roles?

Stephanie's not offended. Curious.

STEPHANIE

Define traditional.

DIGITAL MAN #3

I believe a man should lead his family. Protect. Provide.

Stephanie cocks her head. Interested what comes next.

DIGITAL MAN #3

I think modern relationships fail because nobody wants to be submissive anymore.

STEPHANIE

What does submissive mean to you?

Digital Man #3 shrugs confidently.

DIGITAL MAN #3

I lead, you follow.

Stephanie's eyes narrow, quickly raises a finger.

POP!! The sound is much louder.

Digital Man #3 freezes then dissolves into digital fragments.

The SERVER approaches.

SERVER

Third cycle this month.

Stephanie looks up. Earbuds switch to local listening mode.

STEPHANIE

I'm sorry?

The Server hesitates.

SERVER

Would you like to see the menu?

STEPHANIE

No, I'm too anxious to eat.

Earbud switch color, back into digital mode.

SCENE 07

DIGITAL MARK - OPTIMIZED PROFILE AVATAR

INT GIALLO'S - STEPHANIE'S TABLE - DAY

DIGITAL MAN #4MARK (mid 30s). Attractive. Fit. Stable career. Marriage-minded. Less animated than the others. She selects him.

DIGITAL MARK

Everything I'm allowed to discuss
is listed in my profile.

STEPHANIE

You'd like marriage in two years?

DIGITAL MARK

Correct.

STEPHANIE

Children?

DIGITAL MARK

Very much.

A beat.

DIGITAL MARK

Twins run in my family.

He smiles and holds eye contact.

DIGITAL MARK

I'm serious about building
something real.

Her pupils dilate, then narrow.

STEPHANIE

Schedule in-person verification.

A MATCH.

MEETING CONFIRMED

TITLE CARD: NEXT WEEK

Digital Mark smiles as his avatar dissolves. Stephanie watch

the empty air a moment too long.

SCENE 08

ONE WEEK LATER - STEPHANIE NIGHT WAITS - REAL MARK ENTERS

INT GIALLO'S - NIGHT - CYAN + AMBER

INT. RESTAURANT - NIGHT - ONE WEEK LATER

Same table. Stephanie waits. The SERVER approaches.

SERVER

The regular?

Stephanie nods. Perfect posture. Composed.

The front door to the restaurant slides open. MARK enters.

He is...very human. Slightly softer than his hologram.
Thinning hair. A bit heavier. Nervous.

He spots her. He freezes - stunned. Slowly walked over.

MARK

You're...exactly like your profile.

A small smile.

STEPHANIE

You're not.

Mark exhales.

MARK

Yeah.

(beat)

Everyone enhances a little. I
just...well...maybe a little more.

SCENE 09

REAL MARK DATE - MAIN CONVERSATION

INT GIALLO'S - NIGHT - TWO-TOP

He sits. Awkward.

MARK

I almost didn't come.

STEPHANIE

Why?

MARK

Because I figured you'd walk out
once you saw me.

She studies him carefully. Measuring.

STEPHANIE

I noticed.

His face falls slightly. He lowers his head.

A long pause. Then-

STEPHANIE

But I'm still here.

Mark lifts his head.

STEPHANIE

Can I ask you something honest?

MARK

You can ask.

STEPHANIE

Do you believe in traditional
roles?

Stephanie watches him carefully now.

MARK

Define traditional.

STEPHANIE

A man's role and a woman's role in

a relationship.

MARK

I believe a man should be the first one up on the morning. Setting the day for his family. He must provide. And he must protect.

STEPHANIE

Should a woman obey...submit?

MARK

Obeys to control. IF, you lead well enough that she feels safe...she will follow, naturally.

Stephanie studies him.

STEPHANIE

And what if she's stronger than you expected?

A small smile crosses his face.

MARK

Than I'd better become stronger too.

Silence stretches. Stephanie sips her tea. Mark watches her.

STEPHANIE

I don't think submission is weakness.

MARK

I think submission is trust.

They both nod in agreement.

STEPHANIE

How do you like this dating app?

MARK

I'm tired of holograms.

(beat)

I don't need perfect. Just something real. A good wife. Kids. A happy life.

Stephanie feels the sincerity. Her pupils dilate-hold a fraction too long.

MARK

I know that sounds ancient.

STEPHANIE

It sounds sincere.

He smiles.

MARK

Would you want that? A good husband. Kids. A happy life?

STEPHANIE

Yes.

Too fast. She recalibrates.

STEPHANIE

That would be nice.

Mark leans forward.

MARK

If someone wasn't exactly what you expected...Could you still choose them?

She returns his gaze. Her lips part, then close.

STEPHANIE

NO.

Her pupils constrict. She smiles.

STEPHANIE

I mean...

Stephanie blinks twice. Then blinks harder.

STEPHANIE

I mean Yes...I could.

Mark studies her.

MARK

So...

STEPHANIE

So...what?

MARK

So...would you like to try? Not the app. Not the hologram. Just us.

Another micro-hesitation.

Yes. **STEPHANIE**

SCENE 10

TOUCH - GOODBYE - HAND KISS

INT GIALLO'S - NIGHT - TABLE -> EXIT

He exhales in relief. Reaches across the table.

She hesitates. Slowly places her hand in his.

MARK

Next week?

No response. Just a blank stare.

A beat:

STEPHANIE

Next week.

He smiles-open, vulnerable, hopeful.

He stands.

MARK

I'll hologram you.

STEPHANIE

The real you?

Mark laughs.

MARK

Yes. The real me.

Stephanie smiles. Remains seated.

STEPHANIE

That's the one I like.

He smile. Takes her hand and kisses it.

STEPHANIE

Next week.

Mark looks back, smiles, then exits. The door slides shut.

SCENE 11

SIMULATION REVEAL

INT GIALLO'S -> SYSTEM SPACE

Stephanie remains seated. Still. Staring at the door.

The restaurant noise fades. Her pupils dilate.

The warmth drains from her face. She blinks once. Then twice. The room disappears. She's in darkness. A hologram message appears.

ADAPTIVE HUMAN SIMULAITON: IMPROVEDLONG-TERM PAIR BOND
PROBABIIITY: 78%REPRODUCTION CAPABILITY: NOT
INSTALLEDDIRECTIVE: MAINTAIN HUMAN IDENTITY.

She blinks twice. Normal restaurant. Normal lights.

She looks down at her hand. The skin tone shifts microscopically-recalibrating.

She looks down at her hand. The skin reseals. Flawless.

She looks toward the door where Mark exited.

STEPHANIE

(Softly)

Next week.

Her voice warm.

The computer screen briefly displays.

UNIT 5ST-9-SOCIAL INTERGRATION PROGRESS: SUCCESSFUL

The Server approaches.

SERVER

More tea?

Stephanie snaps out of focus mode. Registers the server. Smiles, nods.

FADE TO BLACK.

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